

Cyber Security Engineer Roadmap 2026

This roadmap is designed for Porallla Chandu to become a Cyber Security Engineer in 2026. It includes a step-by-step learning path, certifications, practical labs, tools, projects, job preparation strategy, salary growth path, and a realistic execution plan.

1. Understand the Cyber Security Field

Cyber Security protects systems, networks, cloud infrastructure, applications, and data from attacks.

Main domains:

- Network Security
- SOC Analyst
- Penetration Testing
- Cloud Security
- Security Engineering
- Application Security
- Malware Analysis
- Threat Intelligence
- Governance, Risk & Compliance

2. Best Path for You (Recommended)

Since you already have networking and Java Full Stack knowledge, the best path is:

Networking → Linux → Cyber Security Basics → SOC/PenTesting → Cloud Security → Security Engineer.

This gives faster job opportunities and stronger long-term growth.

3. Core Skills Roadmap

Phase 1 – Networking Foundations

- CCNA Concepts
- TCP/IP
- Routing & Switching
- DNS, DHCP, NAT, VLANs
- Firewalls & VPNs
- Wireshark Packet Analysis

Phase 2 – Operating Systems

- Linux Administration
- Windows Security Basics
- User Permissions
- Bash Commands
- File Systems
- Process Management

Phase 3 – Programming & Scripting

- Python for Automation
- Bash Scripting
- PowerShell Basics
- APIs & JSON
- Automation Scripts

Phase 4 – Security Fundamentals

- CIA Triad
- OWASP Top 10
- Cryptography
- Authentication & Authorization
- SIEM Basics
- Incident Response
- Threat Hunting

Phase 5 – Advanced Cyber Security

- Ethical Hacking
- Vulnerability Assessment
- Metasploit
- Burp Suite
- Nmap
- Active Directory Security
- Cloud Security
- SOC Operations

4. Certifications Roadmap (2026 Best Order)

Beginner Level:

1. Cisco CCNA
2. Google Cybersecurity Certificate
3. CompTIA Security+

Intermediate Level:

4. CEH (Certified Ethical Hacker)
5. eJPT
6. CompTIA CySA+

Advanced Level:

7. OSCP
8. CISSP
9. AWS Security Specialty
10. Azure Security Engineer

Most Valuable Combination:

CCNA + Security+ + CEH/eJPT + OSCP

5. Best Platforms for Practice

- TryHackMe
- Hack The Box
- PortSwigger Web Security Academy

- OverTheWire
- PicoCTF
- Cisco Packet Tracer
- Kali Linux Labs

6. Important Tools to Master

Networking:

- Wireshark
- Cisco Packet Tracer
- GNS3

Security Tools:

- Nmap
- Burp Suite
- Metasploit
- Nessus
- Splunk
- Kali Linux
- OpenVAS
- Nikto

7. Projects You Should Build

1. Home SOC Lab
2. Vulnerability Scanner
3. Secure Login System
4. Network Monitoring Dashboard
5. Packet Sniffer
6. SIEM Log Analysis Project
7. Web Security Testing Lab
8. Firewall Configuration Lab

8. Job Roles You Can Target

- SOC Analyst
- Cyber Security Analyst
- Security Engineer
- Network Security Engineer
- Penetration Tester
- Incident Response Analyst
- Cloud Security Associate

9. Salary Expectations (India 2026 Approx.)

Fresher:

■4 LPA – ■8 LPA

With Certifications + Labs:

■8 LPA – ■15 LPA

Advanced Skills + OSCP:

■15 LPA – ■30 LPA

International Remote Opportunities:

■30 LPA+ possible with strong practical skills.

10. 12-Month Execution Plan

Months 1–2:

- Networking Revision
- Linux Basics
- Python Basics

Months 3–4:

- Security Fundamentals
- Security+ Preparation
- TryHackMe Beginner Labs

Months 5–6:

- Web Security
- Burp Suite
- Nmap
- CEH/eJPT Preparation

Months 7–8:

- Build Security Projects
- Resume Optimization
- LinkedIn Branding
- GitHub Projects

Months 9–10:

- Advanced Labs
- SOC Monitoring
- Splunk
- Active Directory

Months 11–12:

- Interview Preparation
- Apply for Jobs
- Freelancing
- Cloud Security Basics

11. Interview Preparation Topics

- OSI Model

- TCP vs UDP
- DNS Attacks
- SQL Injection
- XSS
- Firewall Types
- VPN
- SIEM
- Incident Response
- Linux Commands
- Active Directory
- OWASP Top 10

12. Final Advice

Consistency matters more than speed.

Spend at least:

- 2 hours daily learning
- 1 hour practicing labs
- 1 project every month

Focus heavily on practical skills, GitHub projects, LinkedIn presence, and certifications.

Your networking background gives you a strong advantage in Cyber Security.

Certification Priority Table

Certification	Level	Value
CCNA	Beginner	Networking Foundation
Security+	Beginner	Security Fundamentals
CEH	Intermediate	Ethical Hacking
eJPT	Intermediate	Practical PenTesting
OSCP	Advanced	Top Practical Certification
CISSP	Advanced	Enterprise Security